

ZAIN AFZAL

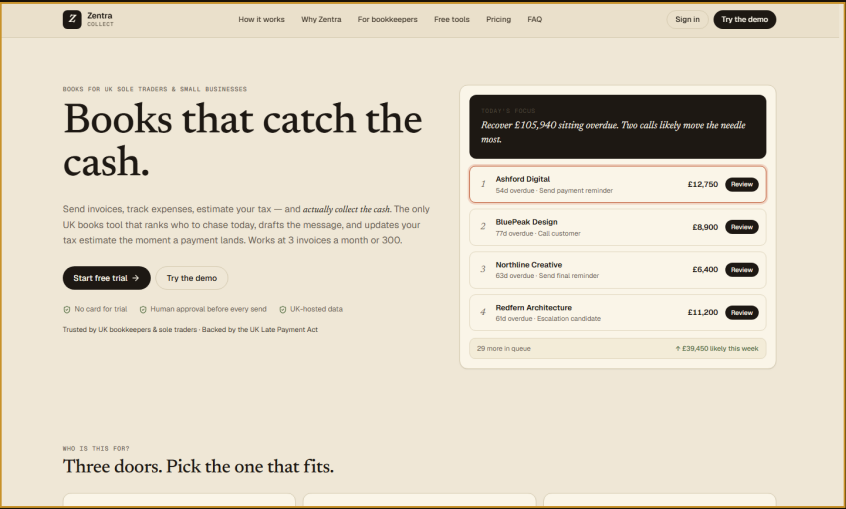
Graduate Finance Analyst

- BSc Economics & Accounting
- 1 Year Finance Assistant
- Zentra Collect — SaaS Finance Product

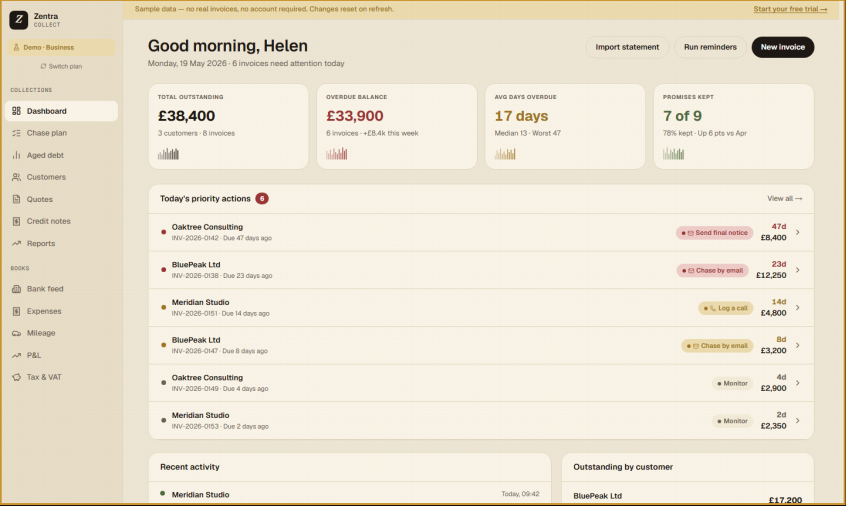
FEATURED PROJECT

Zentra Collect is a collections decisioning tool I designed and built for UK small businesses — turning overdue invoices into a ranked chase plan with AI-drafted messages, HMRC-aligned expense tracking, and a live cash flow view.

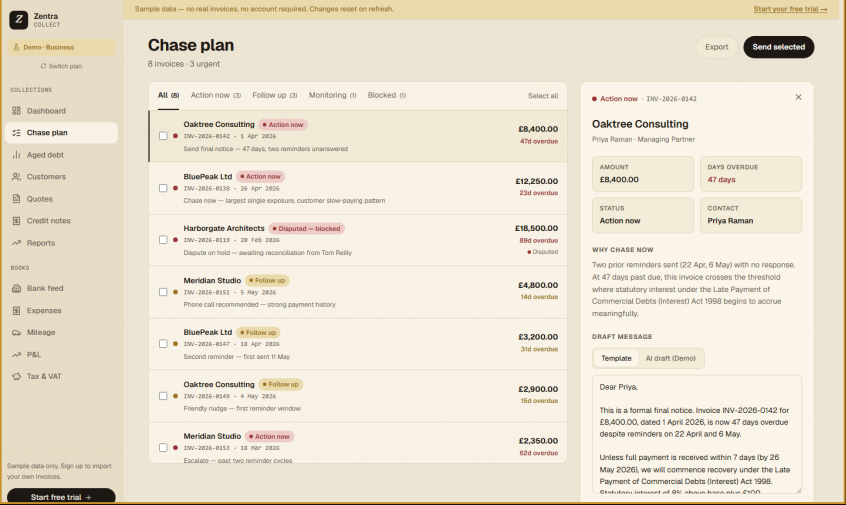
zentracollect.co.uk



Landing page — zentracollect.co.uk



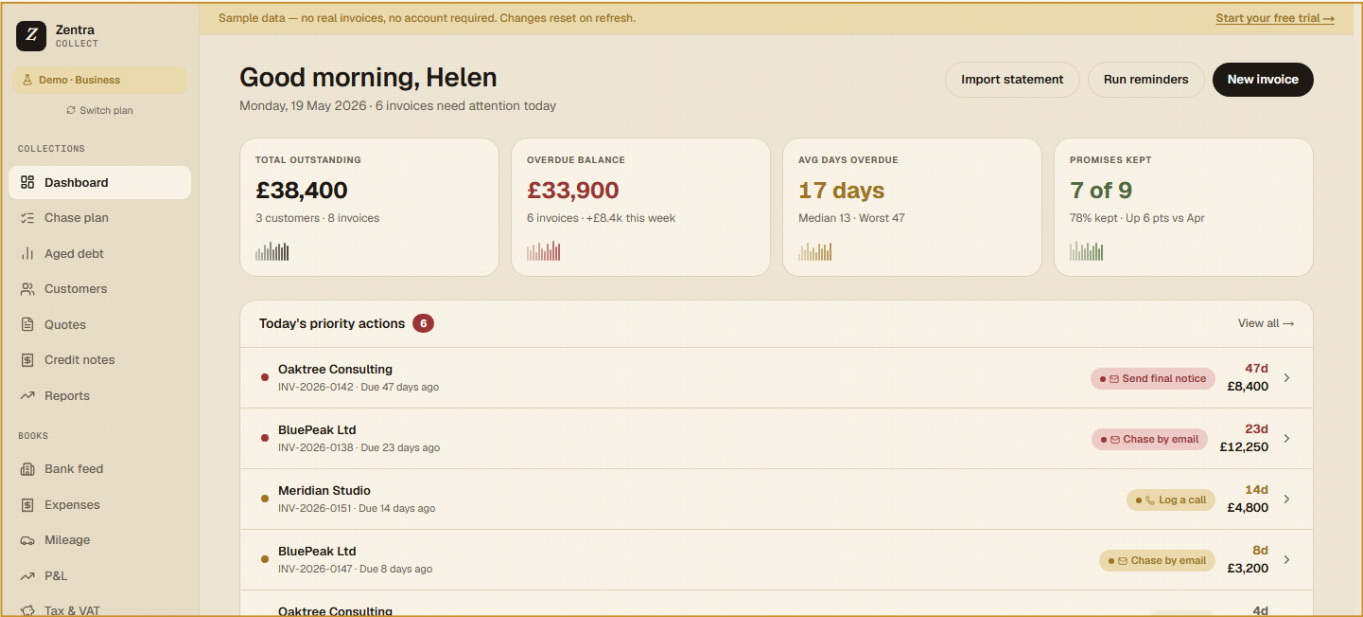
Dashboard — KPIs, priority actions, customer breakdown



Chase plan — ranked invoice queue with AI draft message

Zentra Collect — Collections Decisioning for UK Small Businesses

A full-stack SaaS product built from scratch · Live at zentracollect.co.uk



Live demo dashboard — KPI cards, priority actions, and outstanding by customer

THE PROJECT

Zentra Collect turns overdue invoice exports into a ranked collections plan — who to chase, what to do, and exactly what message to send. Every recommendation shows the action, a plain-English reason, and a draft email ready to approve. The product is live, publicly accessible, and handles the full invoice-to-cash workflow for UK small businesses and bookkeepers.

THE PROBLEM I SOLVED

UK small businesses lose billions to unpaid invoices each year — not because they can't collect, but because they don't know *who* to chase or *when*. Existing tools show what is overdue; none explain what to do. Zentra Collect closes that gap with a ranked, explainable chase plan backed by UK credit control logic.

MY ROLE

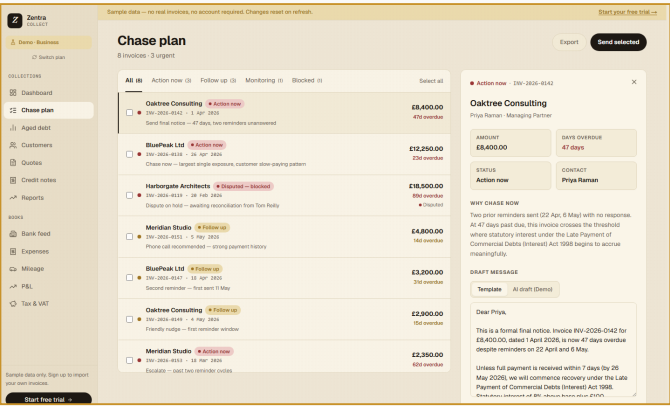
- **Collections algorithm** — ranked by overdue days, amount, payment history, dispute flags
- **HMRC expense tracker** — 11 category groups, 70+ line items, allowability flags, VAT logic
- **AI-drafted messages** — server-side only, human approval gate before every send
- **Aged debt reporting** — 30/60/90+ day buckets per customer, CSV export
- **Bank feed import** — statement reconciliation, direct income, rolling cash view
- **Full launch** — pricing, free trial, demo environment, public website

SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

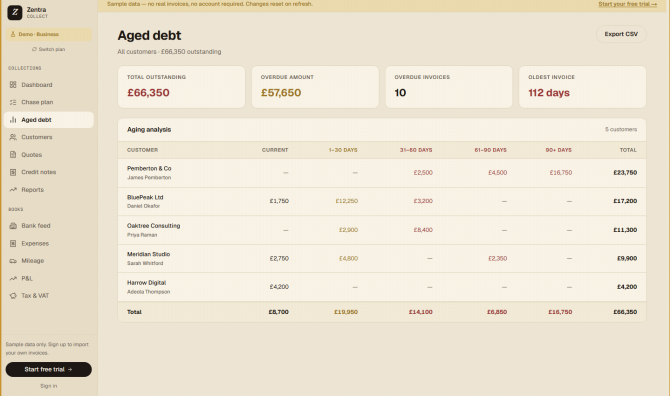
- Aged debt analysis
- HMRC allowability
- Cash flow
- UK Late Payment Act
- Collections decisioning
- Financial reporting
- Credit control
- SaaS product design

Financial Features & Domain Knowledge

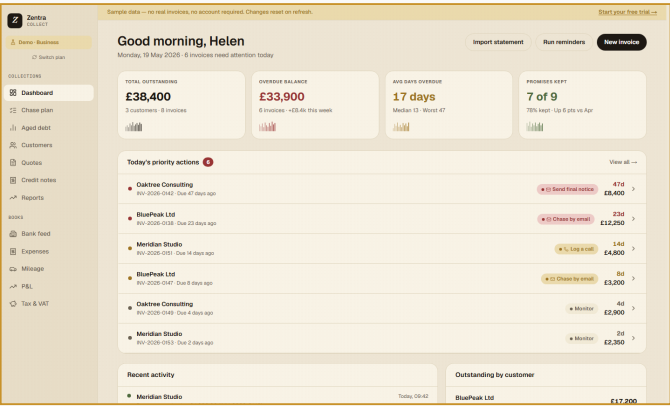
How UK finance knowledge is built into every layer of the product



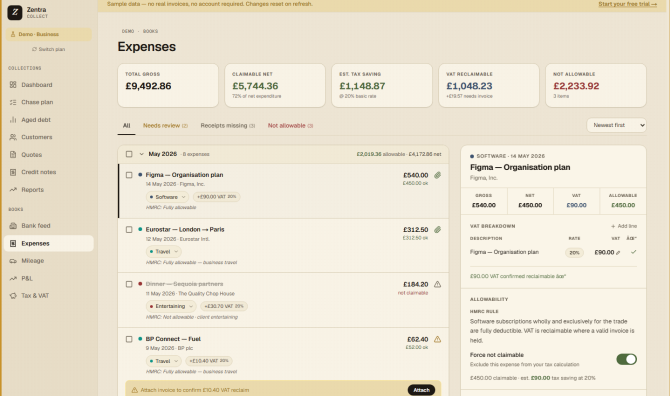
Chase plan — ranked invoices with AI-drafted message panel open



Aged debt — 30 / 60 / 90+ day buckets per customer



Dashboard — KPI cards and priority action queue



HMRC expenses — VAT, allowability rules, category grouping

Collections Algorithm

Ranked by overdue days x amount x payment history. Statuses: Action now / Follow up / Monitor / Blocked. UK Late Payment of Commercial Debts Act thresholds built in.

HMRC Expense Tracker

11 category groups, 70+ line items. s34 ITTOIA 2005 allowability flags, VAT reclaimability, live tax estimate.

Aged Debt Analysis

30 / 60 / 90+ day buckets per customer — matching the standard credit control format used by UK finance teams.

Cash Flow & Bank Reconciliation

Rolling bank statement import, direct income capture, and a live P&L; — from invoice raised to cash confirmed.

What I built, what I learned, and why it matters for finance

Zentra Collect | Live product | zentracollect.co.uk

£66,350

outstanding debt
managed in demo

112 days

oldest invoice
flagged for action

70+

HMRC expense
categories covered

7 of 9

promises kept
tracked per client

WHAT I LEARNED

- **Finance logic is the hard part.** Getting the collections ranking right — when the Late Payment Act clock starts, when to escalate vs snooze — required deep research into real UK credit control practice.
- **HMRC rules are nuanced.** Building the expense tracker meant reading s34 ITTOIA 2005, HMRC's simplified expenses guidance, and the 50% entertainment rule in detail. That knowledge now lives in the product.
- **Cash flow is not profit.** Building the P&L and bank reconciliation features made this distinction viscerally real — not just a textbook concept.
- **Show your working.** Every recommendation explains its reasoning. The same principle applies to any financial analysis I present.

FINANCE SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

Credit control & collections

Aged debt analysis, escalation logic, UK Late Payment Act

HMRC compliance

Expense allowability (s34 ITTOIA 2005), VAT reclaim, Self-Assessment

Cash flow management

Bank reconciliation, direct income capture, rolling period view

Financial reporting

KPI dashboards, month-end concepts, variance analysis, CSV exports

Commercial awareness

Pricing strategy, SaaS unit economics, UK SME market research

Data & analysis

Ranking algorithm, risk scoring, payment pattern detection

"I built Zentra Collect to prove I understand finance, not just spreadsheets. Every feature is grounded in real UK credit control practice, HMRC rules, and the questions a business owner actually needs answered every morning."